Food Remedy API

Competitive App Research: RE003 – Allergen Detection Labelling Standards (Australia)

Prepared For: Food Remedy API Team

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1. Mandatory Allergen Declarations

Under **Standard 1.2.3 and Schedule 9** of the Food Standards Code, food labels must **declare** if the product contains (as ingredient, additive, processing aid, or within a compound ingredient):

- Gluten-containing cereals**: wheat, rye, barley, oats** (if gluten present)
- Crustacea, mollusc, fish
- **Egg, milk, lupin, peanut, soy, sesame**
- **Tree nuts** (individually: **almond, brazil nut, cashew, hazelnut, macadamia, pecan, pine nut, pistachio, walnut)**
- **Sulphites** if ≥ 10 mg/kg

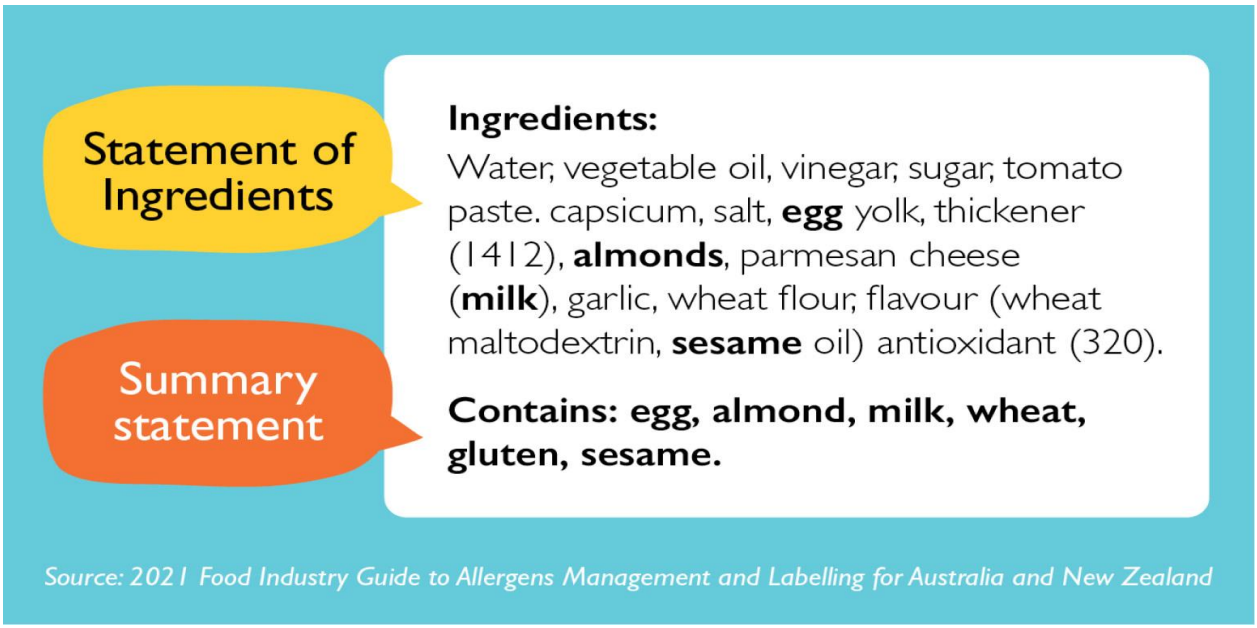

Figure 1: Real-world label showing allergens like egg, milk, and sesame declared clearly in the ingredient list.

2. Plain English Allergen Labelling (PEAL)

Effective for packaging after 25 Feb 2024 (existing stock until 25 Feb 2026), PEAL mandates:

- **Bold** allergen names in **plain English** within the ingredients list (e.g., “milk” not “casein”)
- A separate “**Contains**” summary statement using the same allergen names (font size ≥ ingredient list), placed adjacent or beneath
- **Tree nuts, cereals, seafood** must be declared **individually** (e.g., “almond” instead of “tree nut”)
- **May contain** or advisory statements are **voluntary** and must appear on their own line if used

Figure 2: PEAL label formatting infographic outlining required allergen bolding and placement of 'Contains' line.

3. Additional Labelling Context

- Sulphites declared at ≥ 10 mg/kg
- Foods sold unpackaged (e.g., from cafes, bakeries) aren't labelled but **must provide allergen info upon request**
- **Bulk/trader-packaged foods** must have accompanying allergen details

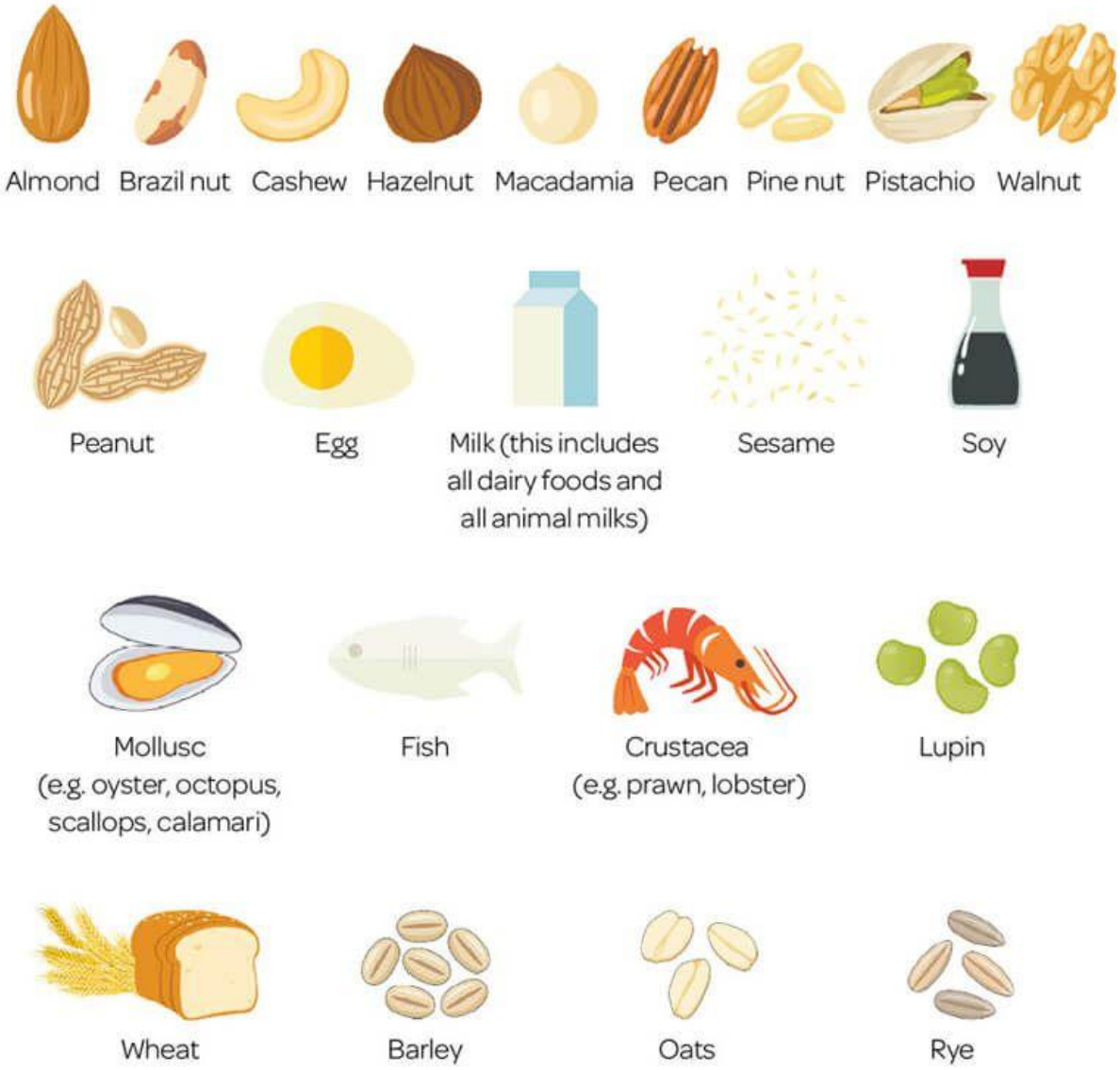

Figure 3: Example of a warning label or signage indicating allergen information must be requested for unpackaged foods.

4. Visual Examples & Formatting

- **Ingredient lists** with bold allergen terms, e.g.:
  *"ingredients: water, vegetable oil, vinegar, sugar, **… egg yolk, almonds,** parmesan cheese **(milk)**, …"*, with "**Contains: egg, almond, milk, wheat, sesame"** summary
- Infographics highlighting **individual tree nuts**, cereals, seafood, etc
- Mixed visuals showing "Allergen Labeling Saves Lives" featuring **seafood**, **tree nuts**, **wheat**, **milk**

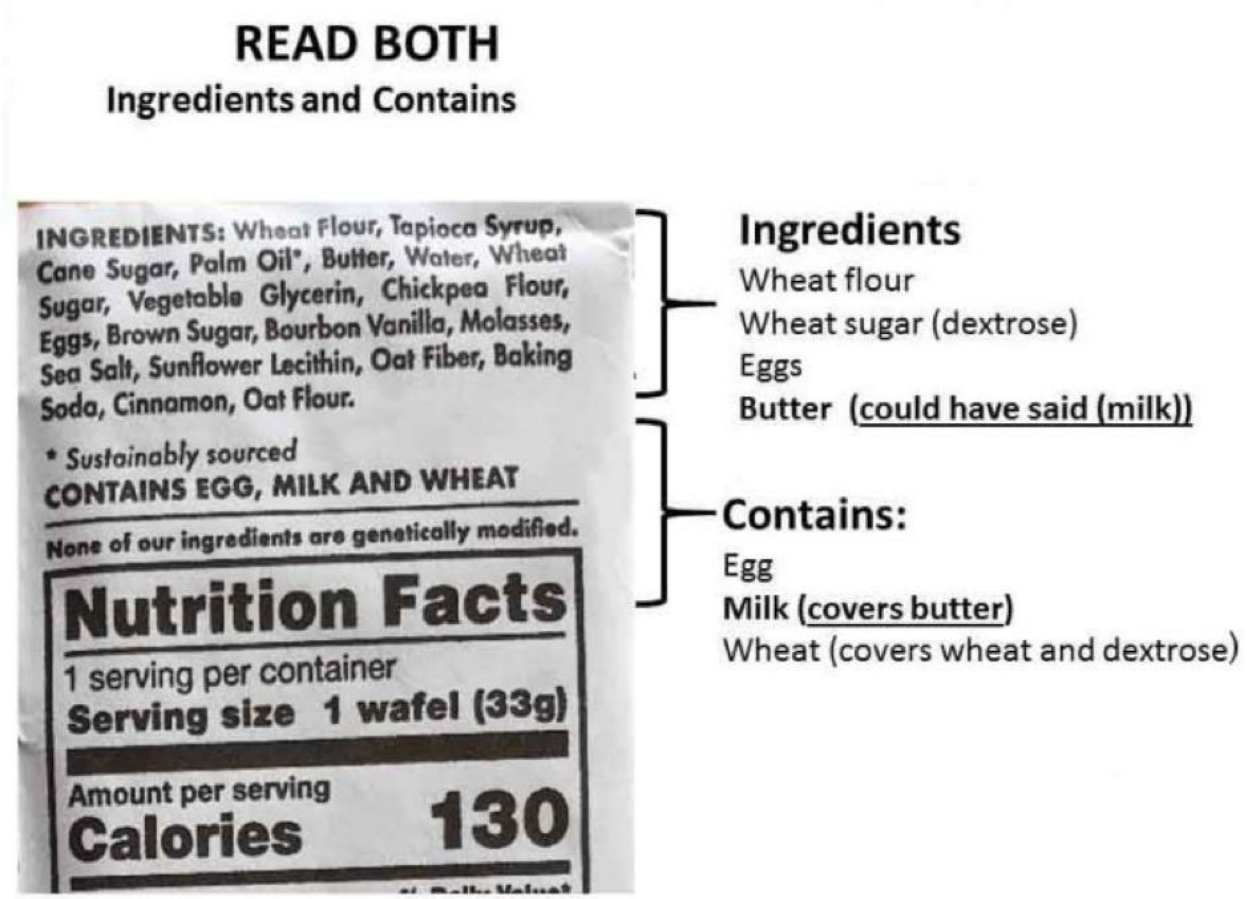

Figure 4: Mixed allergen visual showing various declared ingredients (tree nuts, seafood, wheat, milk) and clear label formatting.

5. Summary Table

Aspect	Requirement
Bold terms	Allergens in ingredient list (plain English)
"Contains:" line	Separate bold summary statement (same or larger font size)
Individual names	Tree nuts, cereals, seafood declared individually
Sulphites	Must be declared if ≥ 10 mg/kg
Voluntary warnings	"May contain" lines allowed, must be standalone
Unpackaged foods	Allergen info must be available on request

References

1. Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ). (2021). *Plain English Allergen Labelling (PEAL)*. Retrieved from https://www.foodstandards.gov.au/industry/peal/Pages/default.aspx
2. Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ). (2023). *Food Standards Code – Standard 1.2.3: Information Requirements – Warning Statements, Advisory Statements and Declarations*. Retrieved from https://www.foodstandards.gov.au/code/
3. Allergy & Anaphylaxis Australia. (2022). *Reading food labels for allergen information*. Retrieved from https://allergyfacts.org.au/resources/reading-food-labels
4. Department of Health Australia. (2022). *Food Allergies and Labelling Requirements*. Retrieved from https://www.health.gov.au/